

N | L NATHAN LINDIG

CHARACTER TECHNICAL ARTIST


Bryan, TX


(214) 548-3845


nathanlindig@gmail.com


nathanlindig.com

Character Technical Artist with 8+ years of industry experience in character rigging, deformation systems, and Python scripting for real-time and pre-rendered productions. Experienced in building rigs for characters, creatures, and props; developing Maya tools that improve artist workflows; and working closely with animators to achieve engaging performances. Shipped the Emmy Award-winning interactive film Baba Yaga (Baobab Studios, 2020) and avatar systems reaching hundreds of millions of users across Meta's family of apps.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Visualization *Texas A&M University*
College Station, TX, 2016 - 2021

Bachelor of Science in Visualization *Texas A&M University*
College Station, TX, 2012 - 2016

SKILLS

Maya, Python, ZBrush, Substance Painter, Photoshop, Unity3D, USD, Houdini, Git, Perforce, C#, JSON

WORK EXPERIENCE

CHARACTER TECHNICAL ARTIST *Meta / Menlo Park, CA / Nov 2022 – Jan 2026*

- Technical lead of the auto-skinning system for clothing in Meta's Avatar 2.0 pipeline. Developed a robust, procedural skin weight transfer system in Python/Maya, and led R&D on a node-based implementation.
- Co-developed a deformation transfer framework in Python/Maya built around mesh correspondence operators and post-transfer refinement, serving as the foundation for auto-skinning and auto-fit systems across Meta's avatar pipeline.
- Designed and built 11 proxy meshes with a procedural generation pipeline and headless Maya batch process that automatically propagated hundreds of blendshape targets across all proxies, resolving clothing fit artifacts across body types and enabling the July 30, 2025, Aspirational Bodies launch.
- Directed a team of ~7 artists to manually produce skin weight data for ~80% of the Style 2 clothing catalog while simultaneously leading R&D on a replacement procedural transfer system.
- Led end-to-end development of a Maya-based toolset for 3 external vendors that reduced internal technical production support by ~40%. Owned requirements, development, shipping, onboarding, and ongoing updates.
- Collaborated with Engineers and PMs on proprietary Auto-LOD, Auto-Fit, and garment layering systems.

3D ARTIST (CONTINGENT) *Meta / Menlo Park, CA / Feb 2021 – Nov 2022*

- Personally sculpted 40+ blendshape updates across all facial feature categories — face shapes, nose shapes, mouth shapes, and eye shapes — for the Jan 31, 2022 avatar update, critical to Meta's launch of avatars on Instagram.
- Collaborated with another TA on a rig-driven eye shape system, providing feedback and direction as the primary artist user — the rig procedurally generated animation shapes (open/close) for each eye shape variant, ensuring correct performance across all options.
- Technical lead on a complete overhaul of the avatar hair system, bridging art and engineering to enable anisotropic shading and Substance Painter tooling for flow map authoring and visualization.
- Developed three Maya GUI tools that improved production speed and artistic control: sideburn conforming, stylized hair normal transfer, and automated material setup.

CG GENERALIST *Baobab Studios / Redwood City, CA / 2019 – Feb 2021*

- Rigged all props for the VR experience Baba Yaga and built the engine-compatible rig for the character of Baba Yaga, designed for Baobab's proprietary two-tier deformation system enabling high-fidelity Maya performance to be approximated in Unity.
- Closely collaborated with animators throughout production to ensure consistent, effective, and intuitive rig performance across all character props.
- Formalized scattered export scripts into a structured Maya GUI tool, simplifying the proprietary rigging data export process for the team.
- Developed a VR-performant custom theatrical lighting system using painted light masks and a custom shader to animate lighting scenarios without real-time lights.